2024 Seed Grant Call for Proposals

May 20, 2024

To whom it may concern,

In regard of the Call for Proposals for the 2024 Sociology Department Seed Grants, I'm submitting my application with all the requirements specified. My main field of research is political sociology and Marxist political economy. As the faculty in the department knows, I came to the program to study the relationship between antimining struggles, the capitalist reproduction process as a whole, and the situation of shared imperialism in the Andes of South America. This seed grant will fund the first stage of my research project by stablishing the empirical base for the analysis of the antimining contention in Ecuador, Colombia, and Peru, by the means of archival research in the construction of a protest event catalog of antimining campaigns of struggle, and the interviews and ethnography of the anti-mining struggles developing currently in the region.

My proposal will be coordinated and discussed with my Thesis Chair William Robinson, who will be faculty advisor since the second year. My estimate year of graduation for the M.A. is spring 2025 and for the PhD in September 2028, and my email address for contact is: mejiavillena@ucsb.edu.

I'm attaching to this cover letter the complete proposal with the CV.

Sincerely,

José Manuel Mejía Villena
A1P0N90
Graduate student
Sociology Department
University of California Santa Barbara

The effects of anti-mining struggles over capital reproduction and shared imperialism in the Andes

José Manuel Mejía V.
mejiavillena@ucsb.edu

Purpose and objectives of the project

The projected study have two objectives: 1) the comparative analysis of three cases of anti-mining contention, and 2) the Marxist analysis of the impact of these struggles over the rate of surplus value and rate of profit of mining different capitals. The analysis of the class struggle involved in anti-mining contentious campaigns from a historical political sociology (Tilly 2008), can orient theoretically the evidence about the operation of the mechanism and processes of contention between the indigenous-peasantry and the imperialist mining bourgeoisie (Lust 2016; 2019; Veltmeyer 2022).
Nevertheless, the effects of the process of scale shift of anti-mining contention in the Andes should be addressed by a Marxist analysis of the impact of these anti-mining campaigns of struggle had over the profits of the transnational mining corporations since the beginnings of the XXI century. Both necessities for the advancement in the study of extractive contention in a multilevel polity approach (Imig and Tarrow 2001) are grounded also in the increasingly growing literature on geo-economics and geopolitical current affairs which consider the centrality of certain strategic resources with certain material features which determine its possibilities for production and transportation (Ross 2015; 2004).

Planned activities

Three initial exploratory case studies are proposed considering field work and archive research in Colombia, Ecuador, and Peru. The first objective will be accomplished by a combination of mixed methods starting with interviews to activists and scholars, I will select a subnational circumscription to initiate first archival research intended to build a catalog of protest events (Tilly 2002; Hutter 2014) useful to compare at least three campaigns of anti-mining struggles. In this phase of my sociology master thesis, the second objective will be accomplished by studying the contribution of Marx on the Book 3 of Capital and on his Economic Manuscript of 1864-1865 (Marx 2016) on the configuration of the rate of profit and it's further division, considering the contributions also made by the theories on imperialism, global capitalism, transnational capitalist class and state (Robinson 2022; 2020), and of hegemonic transitions (Arrighi and Silver 1999), but focusing on the concrete analysis of transnational mining production in the Andes.

Expected contributions of the project

The main contribution of this study to the international understanding of the world current affairs will be to develop a theoretically oriented and empirically prospective interpretation of the antimining struggles as a sector of a broader field of extractive contention which is in the core of the current geopolitical and geo-economic global affairs at a multilevel polity -

i.e.: the Ukrainian and Gaza-Palestina interstate conflicts-, and of the effects of this contentious campaigns on the profits made by transnational mining companies, as a subset of the extractive industry which is in voracious expansion since the 2000's.

Fund use, timeline, and budget

The funding will be used to cost partially the fieldwork in Colombia, Ecuador, and Peru. Mainly the seed grant will be used to cover the transportation costs for fieldwork and arhival research executed during the Summer 2024 quarter.

Concept	Cost ($)	Description
Flight LAX-UIO	300	Air flight ticket Los Angeles – Quito (Ecuador)
Flight UIO-BOG	200	Air flight ticket Quito-Bogotá (Colombia)
Flight BOG-LIM	200	Air flight ticket Bogotá-Lima (Perú)
Flight LIM-LAX	300	Air flight ticket Lima-Los Angeles

Plan for follow up research

Every quarter I will submit a brief report on the use of the funds and the outcome of the research, indicating the execution proportion of the project budget and the achievement of progress in the fieldwork and archival research.

Cited references

Arrighi, Giovanni, and Beverly J. Silver, eds. 1999. *Chaos and Governance in the Modern World System*. Contradictions of Modernity 10. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press.

Hutter, Swen. 2014. “Protest Event Analysis and Its Offspring.” In *Methodological Practices in Social Movements Research*, edited by Donatella Della Porta, 335–67. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Imig, Douglas R., and Sidney Tarrow, eds. 2001. *Contentious Europeans: Protest and Politics in an Emerging Polity*. Governance in Europe. Lanham, Md: Rowman & Littlefield.

Lust, Jan. 2016. "Social Struggle and the Political Economy of Natural Resource Extraction in Peru." *Critical Sociology* 42 (2): 195–210. https://doi.org/10.1177/0896920513501354.

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Marx, Karl. 2016. *Marx's Economic Manuscript of 1864-1865*. Edited by Fred Moseley. Translated by Ben Fowkes. Historical Materialism 100. Leiden ; Boston: Brill.

Robinson, William I. 2020. *The Global Police State*. London: Pluto Press.

———. 2022. *Can Global Capitalism Endure?* First. Atlanta: Clarity Press, Inc.

Ross, Michael L. 2004. "How Do Natural Resources Influence Civil War? Evidence from Thirteen Cases." *International Organization* 58 (1): 35–67. http://www.jstor.org/stable/3877888.

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Tilly, Charles. 2002. "Event Catalogs as Theories." *Sociological Theory* 20:248–54. https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-9558.00161.

———. 2008. *Explaining Social Processes*. London: Paradigm Publishers.

Veltmeyer, Henry. 2022. *América Latina En La Vorágine de La Crisis: Extractivismos y Alternativas*. 1st ed. Bielefeld University Press. https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctv2sbm7k1.

May 2024

JOSÉ MANUEL MEJÍA VILLENA

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EDUCATION

current student
M.A./Ph.D. in Sociology, University of California Santa Barbara – EEUU.

2024
M.A. in Latin American Studies, Universidad Andina Simón Bolivar – Ecuador.

Thesis title: Peasant struggles against the expansion of the extractive frontier. Imperialist mining and class struggle in Cajamarca, Peru.

2021
M.A. in Political Sociology, Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales – Ecuador

Thesis title: Scale shift in the Peruvian antimining contention. Theory building based on the campaigns of struggle over the mining exploration of Quilish mountain in Cajamarca.

2013
B.A. in Political Science, Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos – Peru

SCHOLARSHIPS and FELLOWSHIPS

2023
International Doctoral Recruitment Fellowship, University of California Santa Barbara - EEUU.

2022
Grant for fieldwork in the indigenous community of Huanuara (Tacna), UNMSM - Peru.

2019-2020
Full scholarship to study the M.A. in Latin American Studies, UASB - Ecuador.

2016-2018
Full scholarship to study the M.A. in Political Sociology, FLACSO - Ecuador.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2022
Teaching Assistant in the course Social Movements (Prof. Ph.D. Angélica Ordóñez) at the department of Liberal Arts and Culture Studies, Universidad Andina Simón Bolívar - Ecuador.

2014-2015
Assistant Professor at the School of Political Science and Governance of the Universidad Nacional Micaela Bastidas de Apurimac, Peru.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2022-2023
Thesis researcher of the Critical Joints Project (GI History and Active Citizenship) winner of the research contest of the UNMSM, Peru.

2020-2021
Researcher and coordinator of the protest event analysis project to update the Social Protest Database Peru (BPSP) filling the period 2016-2020. Project director: Professor Moises Arce (Tulane University).

2016-2017
Researcher assistant for the analysis of the Socio-Political Conflicts Database of Ecuador. Project director: Professor Santiago Ortiz (FLACSO-Ecuador).

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

Mejía, José Manuel, and Renzo Ovidio Aurazo. 2015. "Mapeando La Fragmentación de La Contienda Política Transgresiva, Perú 2001-2006." *Conference paper for the VIII Latin American Congress of Political Science - ALACIP*. Lima: Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú.

Mejía, José Manuel. 2013. "Aproximación Teórica a La Fragmentación de La Contienda Política Transgresiva.", *III National Congress of Political Science*. Lima: Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2023- present
Member of the Research Group "Frontiers, Regionalization y Globalization" at CLACSO.

2011- present
Co-founder and Research Associate at the Institute of Andean Political Studies (Instituto de Estudios Políticos Andinos - IEPA), Lima-Peru. Co-founder and Editor of the Journal of Andean Political Studies (Revista Andina de Estudios Políticos - RAEP), ISSN: 22214135, Lima-Peru.

PUBLICATIONS

Thesis

Mejía, José Manuel. 2024. "Luchas campesinas contra la expansión de la frontera extractiva. Minería imperialista y conflicto de clases en Cajamarca, Perú." Tesis de Maestría en Estudios Latinoamericanos, Universidad Andina Simón Bolívar - Ecuador, Quito. http://repositorio.uasb.edu.ec/handle/10644/9715

Mejía, José Manuel. 2021. "Cambio de escala en la contienda anti-minera peruana. Construcción de teoría a partir del conflicto por la exploración del cerro Quilish en Cajamarca." Tesis de Maestría en Sociología Política, Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales - Sede Ecuador, Quito.
https://repositorio.flacsoandes.edu.ec/handle/10469/17341

Journal Articles (Peer Reviewed)

Mejía, José Manuel, and Renzo Aurazo. 2015. "Repensando La Fragmentación de La Contienda Política Transgresiva En El Perú Post-Transición, 2001-2003." Encrucijadas. Revista Crítica de Ciencias Sociales 9.
https://recyt.fecyt.es/index.php/encrucijadas/article/view/79029

Book chapters

Mejía, José Manuel. 2023. "El estallido en los Andes en perspectiva internacional". En *Estallido popular. Protesta y masacre en Perú, 2022-2023*, editado por Gustavo Montoya y Homero Quiroz, 83–94. Lima: Estallido Editorial & Editorial Horizonte.

Reviews

Mejía, José Manuel, and Luis Meléndez. 2017. "Review: La extracción de recursos naturales y la protesta social en el Perú." Revista Andina de Estudios Políticos 101-104 Páginas. doi: 10.35004/RAEP.V7I1.60.
http://www.iepa.org.pe/raep/index.php/ojs/article/view/60

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

2020-current
Co-Founder of the Foundation Surco Común. Organization committed to plan a transition to a peasant agroecological economy and build reciprocal ways of being with nature. Support of monitoring processes of extractive industries, community-based work with environmental organizations, agroecologists and peasants' communities.

2018-2019
Active involvement in the Surco Común agroecological projects of soil rehabilitation, building and non-monetary trade of urban horchatas (during COVID19).